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Faisal D'Souza, NCO
Office of Science and Technology Policy
Executive Office of the President
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

Submitted by email to: [REDACTED]

Re: Request for Information (RFI) on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI)
Action Plan ("Plan")

Introduction

Everfox LLC (Everfox) supports the Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP) in defining the priority policy actions needed to maintain and strengthen America's dominance and innovation in AI. In this submission, we outline specific recommendations for America to maximally benefit from the potential of AI systems, while securing data, and maintaining its AI leadership. As a leader in innovative cybersecurity solutions, Everfox recognizes that robust, forward-thinking policy is critical not only for fostering economic growth and responsible innovation but also for countering the aggressive AI initiatives and escalating threats posed by global competitors, particularly those nations aggressively investing in artificial intelligence to enhance their military, economic, and strategic influence.

Our response presents actionable recommendations that expand on existing government initiatives and underscore the critical need for dynamic public-private collaboration to extend America's continued dominance in AI. In today's rapidly evolving AI landscape—where nation states aggressively integrating AI within their military, offensive and economic strategies posing a significant threat to US AI leadership and security of sensitive data—it is essential for both industry and government to leverage their unique strengths. While industry fuels rapid technological innovation, government ensures these advancements are rigorously evaluated and securely implemented, thereby preserving and enhancing America's competitive advantage in AI.

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About Everfox

Everfox is a leading defense tech company headquartered in Herndon, Virginia, with decades of experience safeguarding the world's most critical data, networks and people. Our critical cybersecurity solutions are designed to protect a diverse range of clients—from cloud service providers and governments to Fortune 50 companies—enabling that even the most sensitive data and environments remain secure.

At Everfox, we specialize in cross domain and multi-level secure information sharing and access solutions that enable organizations to efficiently bridge isolated systems without compromising security. Our innovative approach combines advanced technologies with proactive strategies, empowering our clients to efficiently safeguard their critical assets while maintaining operational resilience in today's dynamic threat landscape. Everfox's Cross Domain Solutions (CDS) actively protects sensitive operations throughout federal agencies, including defense and intelligence communities, by enabling critical information to move securely between classified and unclassified environments.

Recognizing that threats often originate from within, Everfox also provides industry-leading Insider Risk solutions. These advanced capabilities proactively detect, analyze, and respond to internal risks, empowering organizations to protect themselves from threats originating within their own networks.

Driven by a commitment to excellence and a deep understanding of evolving cyber risks, Everfox delivers state-of-the-art, proactive cybersecurity solutions that allow organizations to confidently navigate the challenges of the digital age. For over 25 years we have been an industry leader in protecting sensitive information and maintaining efficient and secure connectivity across diverse and complex environment.

Policy Recommendations

1) Secure AI Mission Operations

AI plays a critical role in advancing mission success for the U.S. Department of Defense (DoD) and Intelligence Community (IC), particularly when data is properly sanitized and secured. Ensuring that AI models operate on validated, clean datasets enhances efficient decision-making capabilities and operational effectiveness while minimizing risks associated with adversarial manipulation.

- **Create and Leverage Secure AI Workflows:** Develop secure infrastructure and best practices to allow AI to operate in controlled, classified, and mission-specific environments where security is prioritized while still enabling rapid innovation.
- **Sanitize and Validate Data Sources:** Ensure Government AI systems are trained on reliable, vetted data to mitigate data poisoning and adversarial exploitation while maintaining operational integrity for DoD and IC missions.

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- **Enhance AI's Role in National Security:** Deploy AI capabilities in critical environments to enable real-time intelligence analysis, mission planning, and battlefield decision-making across multiple domains and classifications utilizing NSA's National Cross Domain Strategy & Management Office (NCDSMO) approved solutions.
- **Mission-Aligned Templates:** Develop preapproved architectural blueprints for AI use cases (e.g., intelligence analysis, mission planning, and real-time threat detection) to accelerate deployment across the DoD and IC.
- **Life Cycle Support and Updates:** Maintain a continuous improvement cycle that efficiently integrates new technology, patches security vulnerabilities, and updates models to reflect the latest threat intelligence—ensuring the AI remains effective and aligned with mission objectives.

2) Secure the AI Supply Chain

The integrity of the AI supply chain is vital for preserving America's technological leadership and national security. Because adversaries target every aspect of AI development—hardware, software, data, algorithms, and personnel—it is imperative to establish a comprehensive security framework that efficiently protects against vulnerabilities, espionage, and supply chain attacks. A multi-layered, proactive approach is needed to ensure AI remains a trustworthy and resilient driver of national security and innovation.

- **Prevent Intellectual Property Theft:** Recent incidents, such as the U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ) action against a Chinese national for stealing AI secrets from Google, underscore the urgent need to protect proprietary technology. We recommend developing standardized protocols and best practices to prevent the infiltration of adversaries into the AI supply chain, ensuring that critical intellectual property remains safeguarded.
- **End-to-End Supply Chain Security:** Implement comprehensive risk management strategies that secure every stage of the AI supply chain. This includes robust evaluation and certification of hardware components, such as semiconductors and chips, as well as stringent security assessments for software development and data acquisition processes.
- **Collaborate Across Sectors:** Establish public-private partnerships that bring together industry leaders, government agencies, and academic institutions to develop and enforce supply chain security standards. This collaboration should focus on efficiently sharing threat intelligence, conducting joint vulnerability assessments, and creating rapid-response frameworks for supply chain incidents.
- **Adopting a Prevention-First Approach:** Transition from reactive, detection-based models to preemptive, prevention-first strategies that secure AI development pipelines and supply chain processes from the outset. This includes integrating preemptive security measures that shield the entire ecosystem from emerging threats and malicious activities.

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3) Establish Secure “AI Factories” for LLM Model Development

America’s leadership in AI hinges on the ability to rapidly develop, test, and deploy AI models in secure environments—particularly within the DoD and the IC. To address this need, we propose creating “AI Factories”: dedicated end-to-end development ecosystems that coordinate every step of the GenAI model life cycle, from design through deployment, with rigorous security controls. These secure facilities would be aligned with national security priorities and tailored to the unique operational requirements of defense and intelligence.

3.1 Build a Dedicated, Trusted Environment

- **Isolated Infrastructure:** Provide a physically and logically segmented environment that houses all aspects of AI model development, from data ingestion to model training, validation, and deployment. This helps prevent outside infiltration and reduces the risk of data exfiltration from data positioning or adversaries.
- **Controlled Access:** Restrict user access to authorized personnel trained in secure AI development practices. Access controls include role-based permissions, regular audits, and stringent background checks to ensure the integrity of the development process.

3.2 Institutionalize Data Management

- **Data Sanitization and Validation:** Implement thorough screening processes for incoming data sets, efficiently removing or flagging corrupted, anomalous, or sensitive information before it enters the training pipeline.
- **Data Valuation and Labeling Standards:** Deploy standardized protocols for labeling: Categorize and catalogue data in ways that align with mission needs. This ensures that the appropriate data is used and that potential vulnerabilities—such as data poisoning—are detected early.

3.3 Adopt a Structured AI Development Life Cycle

- **Secure Model Training:** Require clear documentation of model objectives, data sources, and training parameters to ensure proper oversight. Utilize version control and auditing tools to track changes, enabling swift identification and rollback in the event of anomalies.
- **Continuous Testing and Validation:** Conduct ongoing adversarial testing, penetration analysis, and stress-testing against AI-specific threats—including data poisoning and model inversion attacks—to confirm the resilience of the models prior to deployment.

3.4 Integrate Advanced Cybersecurity Monitoring

- **Insider Risk Detection:** Leverage real-time monitoring tools that use anomaly detection and behavior analytics to identify suspicious data

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access or usage patterns, minimizing the risk of internal threat actors compromising the AI development process.

- **Multi-Domain Security:** Protect workflows that span multiple classification levels (e.g., unclassified, secret, top secret) through cross domain solutions approved by the NSA's National Cross Domain Strategy & Management Office (NCDSMO). This ensures seamless yet secure data sharing and protects against unauthorized cross-contamination.

3.5 Leverage Existing DoD and IC Infrastructure

- **Build on Current Cyber Initiatives:** Align with and expand upon existing defense cybersecurity programs to efficiently consolidate resources, standardize AI security protocols, and avoid duplicative efforts.
- **Facilitate Public-Private Collaboration:** Partner with industry experts who have deep expertise in AI development, insider threat monitoring, and secure data pipelines. This collaboration drives innovation while adhering to strict national security requirements.

Conclusion

Everfox remains steadfast in its commitment to securing American dominance and innovation in AI and cybersecurity. Our submission presents a comprehensive strategy to counter aggressive AI advancements and threats posted by nation-states – mostly notably those targeting U.S. Interests and technology leadership – through a balanced blend of innovative technology and proactive policy measures. By leveraging advanced cross domain solutions, enhancing cybersecurity standards, implementing best practices for internal adversary security prevention and fostering robust public-private collaboration, the United States can efficiently maintain its competitive edge and protect its critical information infrastructure.

Everfox welcomes the opportunity to further discuss these recommendations at the appropriate classification level. Together, we can ensure that America not only meets the challenges of the evolving digital landscape but also reaps the full benefits of advanced AI systems while safeguarding national security.

Sincerely,

Nicole Di Resta
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Everfox LLC